

THE MARRIAGE MANUAL

Build your own instruction manual for married life.

SOME ASSEMBLY REQUIRED

Together, create a funny little instruction manual for married life — full of everyday chaos, inside jokes and surprisingly useful wisdom.

I. DRAW · 1 MINUTE

Each player draws 1–3 *component cards*. The table draws 1 *style card* together. Read them out loud — fun beats logic.

II. BUILD · 5–8 MINUTES

Pick an everyday situation (e.g. “Monday morning,” “the surprise date”). Arrange your cards into a manual that’s logical enough to follow and absurd enough to laugh at. Stay true to your style card — that’s where the comedy lives.

III. PRESENT · 60–90 SECONDS

A volunteer or duo performs your manual for the room. Hold the style. Laughing along is mandatory.

IV. VOTE

Everyone rates with their *star fan* (1 · 3 · 5). Prizes go to the *funniest*, the *most romantic* and the *most painfully accurate* manual.

Winner: a small treat from the couple — bubbly, chocolate, soap.

Big group? Not every table has to present. Whoever wants the spotlight raises their style card — up to four or five tables take the “stage,” ninety seconds each. It stays light, from eight to eighty guests.

The Components

COMPONENT CARDS · SHEET 1 OF 5

COMPONENT

The Remote Control



COMPONENT

The Chocolate Stash



COMPONENT

The GPS Argument



COMPONENT

The Shopping List



COMPONENT

The Romance Kit



COMPONENT

The Sarcasm Filter



COMPONENT

Selective Hearing



COMPONENT

The DIY Toolkit



COMPONENT

The 30-Second Shower



The Components

COMPONENT CARDS · SHEET 2 OF 5

COMPONENT

The Streaming Password



COMPONENT

The Snooze Button



COMPONENT

The Dishwasher Debate



COMPONENT

The Duvet Tug-of-War



COMPONENT

Vacation Planning



COMPONENT

The Fridge Inventory



COMPONENT

*The Morning
Grumpiness Kit*



COMPONENT

Pizza Delivery



COMPONENT

The (Unused) Yoga Mat



The Components

COMPONENT CARDS · SHEET 3 OF 5

COMPONENT

Your Shared Soundtrack



COMPONENT

Emergency Chocolate



COMPONENT

The Patience Elixir



COMPONENT

*The Pizza-Dough
Disaster*



COMPONENT

*The Monday Survival
Kit*



COMPONENT

*The Three-Day Stubble
Question*



COMPONENT

The Chore Spreadsheet



COMPONENT

*The Popcorn Peace
Treaty*



COMPONENT

The Double-Bed Puzzle



The Components

COMPONENT CARDS · SHEET 4 OF 5

COMPONENT

The Shower Queue



COMPONENT

The Spontaneous Road-Trip Kit



COMPONENT

The Argument Time-Out Timer



COMPONENT

The Tropical Daydream Box



COMPONENT

The Weekend Breakfast



COMPONENT

Your Shared Sense of Humor



COMPONENT

The Clothes-Chair Mountain



COMPONENT

The Shared Pillow



COMPONENT

The Green-Tea Ritual



The Components

COMPONENT CARDS · SHEET 5 OF 5

COMPONENT

*The Date-Night
Calendar*



COMPONENT

*The Cleaning-Day
Playlist*



COMPONENT

The Wanderlust Atlas



COMPONENT

A Shared Secret



COMPONENT

The Inside Joke



COMPONENT

Umbrella Moments



COMPONENT

The Phone Battery Level



COMPONENT

The Pillow Barricade



COMPONENT

*The “I’ll Be Ready in
Five” Timeframe*



The Style Cards

HOW TO PRESENT IT · 1 SHEET

STYLE CARD

THE FLAT-PACK MANUAL

*Like a flat-pack furniture guide:
numbered steps, little stick-figure
diagrams, almost no words.*

STYLE CARD

THE TV COMMERCIAL

*Pitch your guide like a 30-second ad: a
jingle, a rhyme, far too much enthusiasm.*

STYLE CARD

GRANDPA'S TALE

*The way Grandpa would tell it: rambling
wisdom, endless detail, at least three
tangents.*

STYLE CARD

THREE WORDS MAX

*Your whole guide: never more than three
words per sentence. Full stop.*

STYLE CARD

THE PRENUP

*As a legal contract: numbered clauses, fine
print, a signature line. Keep it funny.*

STYLE CARD

EXPLAIN IT TO A 7-YEAR- OLD

*So simple a child gets it. So silly the
grown-ups lose it.*

STYLE CARD

THE LOVE POEM

*Your guide is a poem: at least four lines, a
rhythm, all the cheesiness you've got.*

STYLE CARD

THE MEDICINE LEAFLET

*Like a drug package insert: side effects,
dosage, interactions, a stern disclaimer.*